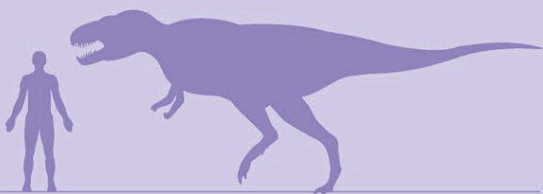


AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 20 ft (6 m)
- **LIVED** 70.6–66 MYA
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **HABITAT** Polar regions



STATS AND FACTS

The word “*nanuq*” means “polar bear” in the language of the indigenous Inupiaq people that live in northwestern Alaska, where the fossils of *Nanuqsaurus* were found. Paleontologists know very little about the appearance of this small tyrannosaurid, as only three fossils have ever been found—a piece each of the upper and lower jaws and a portion of the brain case.

TINY TEETH



Nanuqsaurus had a curious pair of teeth in the lower jaw that were less than half the size of the rest of its teeth.

SKULL SIZE



Paleontologists estimate that *Nanuqsaurus*'s skull measured 24–27½ in (60–70 cm) in length.

ARCTIC TERROR

NANUQSAURUS

One of the smallest tyrannosaurids, *Nanuqsaurus* was about half the length of its more famous cousin, *Tyrannosaurus*. Fossils of this predator were found in a rock formation called Prince Creek in what is now Alaska. During the Late Cretaceous Period, tall mountains formed around this region, cutting it off from areas to the south and stopping the animals that lived here from moving to warmer climates in search of food. The cold and dark winters in the region meant fewer plants and fewer herbivores, reducing the food supply for carnivores that preyed on them. However, *Nanuqsaurus* was able to thrive in the region because its reduced size meant that it could survive on small quantities of food.

Some scientists suggest that *Nanuqsaurus* may have been covered in feathers that kept it warm in its freezing habitat.